COMP396 Weekly Meeting Minutes

(Week 2)

Date & Time: Thursday, February 5th, 2026, 17:00–19:00

Location: Harold Cohen Library, 3rd Floor, Group Study Room 3F

Note Taker: Zhang Olivia

Attendees: Zhang Olivia, Zhao Saria, Xue Ella, Wong Haw

Note: *Due to personal reasons, Xue Ella participated in the entire meeting online via wechat voice.*

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1. Agenda：

- Confirm project deadlines for the new semester (CA2 and CA3).
- Synthesize the updated report and coding requirements for the second phase.
- Review preliminary data analysis of the ten series and discuss strategy replacements.
- Allocate research tasks for the upcoming week.

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2. Discussion & Decisions

2.1. Critical Deadlines

The team confirmed the following submission dates for the current semester:

- **CA2 (Evaluation of Trading Strategies):** March 18th, 2026 (Weight: 30%).
- **CA3 (Final Report and Source Code):** April 29th, 2026 (Weight: 50%).

2.2. Summary of New Phase Requirements

The team reviewed the core guidelines for the final submission:

- **Report Structure (exclude Breakdown) :** The final report must follow a 15:20:15 ratio across three sections: strategy selection logic, justification/risk management, and performance analysis. It must include detailed research overviews, code examples with explanations, and a section on lessons learned.
- **Coding Standards:** All logic must be consolidated into a single T-Strategy class inheriting from backtrader.bt.Strategy. In addition, based on the feedback from the supervisor last semester, we must replace the "Buy and Hold" strategy with one of higher mathematical difficulty.
- **Evaluation Metrics:** Performance will be judged on total Return, the risk-adjusted PD Ratio, and Activity levels (market exposure).
- **Submission Package:** We must submit all source code, including research frameworks (optimization and robustness tests), and a README.txt file. The code execution must not exceed 40 minutes.

2.3. Initial Data Analysis & Strategy Brainstorming

Saria presented the analysis of the ten-asset series (based on Part 2 data), which aligns with the structural characteristics observed in the project data:

- **Asset Observations:**
  - **Series 01:** Strong trend asset; characterized by high returns and high volatility with a clear long-term upward trend.
  - **Series 02:** Shocks / False trend; characterized by low returns and high volatility with an unstable long-term trend.
  - **Series 03:** Slow bull / Stable trend; characterized by medium returns and low volatility with a relatively flat but steady trend.
  - **Series 04:** High-risk strong trend; characterized by extreme returns and extreme volatility with a very prominent upward trajectory.
  - **Series 05:** Downward trend; characterized by negative returns and low volatility with a clear long-term downward trend.
  - **Series 06:** Trend with noise; characterized by high returns and medium-high volatility, but the upward trend is weak and inconsistent.
  - **Series 07:** Typical mean-reversion; characterized by almost no returns and extremely low volatility with a flat trend.
  - **Series 08:** Range-bound; characterized by small returns and low volatility with price action moving within a horizontal range.
  - **Series 09:** Moderate trend; characterized by medium returns and medium volatility with a steady upward trend.

    - **Series 10:** Trend + Noise mixture; characterized by medium-high returns and high volatility with an upward but unstable trend.
- **Strategy Proposal:** To replace "Buy and Hold", ZS initially suggest implementing either a **Trend/Momentum strategy** or **Defensive/Short-selling strategy**.

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3. Task Allocation

To ensure all members are prepared for the finalization strategy, the following tasks are assigned:

ID	Task Description	Owner	Due Date
A1	**Data Analysis (Series 1-3):** Use the Google Colab tool (as recommended by the supervisor) to analyze trends and volatility.	WH	Feb 13
A2	**Data Analysis (Series 4-6):** Use Google Colab to analyze trends and volatility.	ZO	Feb 13
A3	**Data Analysis (Series 7-10):** Use Google Colab to analyze trends and volatility, then perform a comparative analysis with Saria’s initial findings.	XE	Feb 13
A4	**Strategy Research:** Each member must review ZS's proposed strategy suggestions (Trend/Momentum and Defensive/Shorting) and independently research other suitable strategies that meet the mathematical complexity requirements.	All Members	Feb 13

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4. Current Challenges and Issues

- We has currently developed several strategic directions, but the main challenge

it faces is how to transform intuitive and empirical strategic ideas into strategic choices based on Part 2 data analysis, which are interpretable and demonstrable, to meet the requirements of CAS2 for research depth.

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5. Next Meeting Arrangement

- **Date & Time:** Thursday, February 12th, 2026, 10:00–12:00
- **Location:** Harold Cohen Library
- **Key Agenda:**
  - Review the data analysis results from tasks A1-A3 and finalize the data selection process for the report.
  - Share research findings from task A4 and evaluate the feasibility of various strategies.
  - Decision Point: Formally decide on the three specific individual strategies to be implemented in the portfolio.
  - Confirm the mathematical framework for the "Buy and Hold" replacement strategy.